

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | SIEM Engineering | Detection Engineering | Threat Hunting |
Microsoft Sentinel | CrowdStrike NG-SIEM

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Senior Cyber Security Engineer with more than five years of experience specialising in Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) engineering, detection engineering, threat hunting, and Security Orchestration Automation and Response (SOAR)-driven incident response. I have deep hands-on expertise with Microsoft Sentinel and Kusto Query Language (KQL), building detection rules, analytical workbooks, and hunting queries aligned to the MITRE ATT&CK framework. I am also highly proficient with CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM), having managed the platform from data onboarding and connector configuration through to detection tuning and automated response. I bring extensive experience managing enterprise security operations for large, regulated organisations and am comfortable working in fast-paced, compliance-conscious environments such as financial services and asset management. I am adept at translating threat intelligence into actionable detection logic, producing management-level security reporting, and collaborating across security and IT teams to maintain a strong and measurable security posture.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM Engineering:** Microsoft Sentinel, KQL (Kusto Query Language), CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM), detection rule authoring, log source onboarding, correlation logic
- **Detection Engineering:** MITRE ATT&CK-aligned use case development, analytic rule tuning, false positive reduction, detection coverage gap analysis
- **Threat Hunting:** Proactive hunting across SIEM and EDR telemetry, indicator of compromise (IOC) analysis, tactics, techniques, and procedures (TTP) investigation
- **SOAR and Automation:** Automated incident response playbooks, PowerShell scripting for SOAR workflows, alert enrichment and triage automation
- **EDR/XDR:** CrowdStrike Falcon (EDR, Prevent, Insight, Discover), Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender
- **Identity and Access Management:** Microsoft Entra ID, Azure Active Directory (Azure AD), Conditional Access, Multifactor Authentication (MFA), Privileged Access Management (PAM) via BeyondTrust, Single Sign-On (SSO)
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Nessus, AppCheck, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS)
- **Endpoint and Infrastructure Security:** Microsoft Intune MDM/MAM, Tanium, Check Point Harmony firewall, Mimecast email gateway
- **Frameworks and Compliance:** NIST CSF, NIST 800-61 Incident Response, CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL) -- Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 -- Present*

- Led SIEM engineering efforts in Microsoft Sentinel, authoring more than 30 custom KQL detection rules and analytical workbooks mapped to MITRE ATT&CK to improve detection coverage across cloud, endpoint, and identity data sources.
- Administered CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM), managing data connector configuration, detection rule deployment, automated response actions, and platform health monitoring for the enterprise environment.
- Conducted proactive threat hunting across Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon Insight telemetry, investigating anomalous activity patterns, identifying indicators of compromise (IOC), and documenting new detection logic from hunting findings.

- Managed SOAR-driven alert triage workflows, developing PowerShell automation playbooks to enrich, prioritise, and action high-frequency alert categories, reducing mean time to respond (MTTR) by approximately 40%.
- Deployed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft 365 Defender to more than 8,000 users, onboarding telemetry into Sentinel for unified cross-platform detection and response.
- Led incident response investigations in line with NIST 800-61, coordinating containment, eradication, and recovery activities and producing post-incident reports with lessons learned and detection improvement recommendations.
- Maintained and improved SIEM detection baseline through regular rule reviews, false positive tuning, and detection coverage assessments against current threat intelligence and MITRE ATT&CK sub-techniques.
- Managed BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) and Microsoft Entra ID Conditional Access policies to enforce zero-trust identity principles, reducing privileged account exposure and lateral movement risk.
- Generated regular SIEM performance reports, detection coverage metrics, and threat intelligence briefings for senior leadership and the information security governance committee.
- Administered vulnerability management using Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus, and Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), aligning findings to risk appetite and driving remediation prioritisation.
- Leverage Tanium for real-time endpoint compliance monitoring and vulnerability management, using asset discovery, software inventory and patch compliance modules to maintain accurate endpoint visibility and enforce compliance baselines across the estate.

University of the Arts, London (UAL) -- Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 -- March 2025

- Performed day-to-day SIEM alert triage and investigation using Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon, escalating confirmed incidents through defined response procedures in line with NIST 800-61.
- Supported SIEM detection engineering efforts by contributing to the development and testing of new KQL analytic rules and hunting queries across endpoint, identity, and network log sources.
- Deployed and managed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), configuring policies, reviewing alerts, and onboarding new device groups to extend detection coverage across the organisation.
- Managed Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) identity and access controls including user provisioning, MFA enrolment, and Conditional Access policy administration.
- Conducted vulnerability scanning using Tenable.io and Nessus, producing risk-ranked reports and supporting infrastructure teams in tracking remediation progress through to closure.
- Administered Mimecast email security, configuring and tuning anti-phishing, impersonation protection, and attachment sandboxing policies to reduce email-borne threat exposure.
- Contributed to ISO 27001 and Cyber Essentials Plus compliance activities, supporting evidence collection, control gap analysis, and remediation of identified weaknesses.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) -- IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 -- March 2022

- Managed security tooling and monitoring configurations across a cloud-hosted SaaS environment, ensuring continuous visibility of endpoint and infrastructure activity.
- Configured and maintained identity and access management controls including MFA, SSO, and role-based access policies across business-critical applications.
- Supported infrastructure security hardening, device management, and log collection projects, contributing to a more consistent and auditable security baseline.
- Participated in quality assurance activities related to security configurations, identifying deviations from policy baselines and driving timely remediation.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Authored more than 30 custom KQL detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel aligned to MITRE ATT&CK, closing detection gaps across ransomware, credential theft, lateral movement, and data exfiltration threat categories.

- Implemented CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM as the primary detection and response platform, consolidating log ingestion, detection logic, and automated response into a single cloud-native environment.
- Deployed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) to more than 8,000 users, enriching Sentinel with high-fidelity endpoint and identity telemetry for improved detection accuracy.
- Developed SOAR automation playbooks that reduced mean time to respond (MTTR) for common alert categories by approximately 40%, freeing analyst capacity for higher-complexity investigations.
- Produced a SIEM detection coverage report mapped to MITRE ATT&CK that was presented to the Chief Information Security Officer (CISO), informing the organisation's detection investment roadmap.
- Contributed to achieving and maintaining Cyber Essentials Plus certification, ensuring the organisation met the UK Government's baseline cyber security requirements.

EDUCATION

- **M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering**
- **B.Sc. Chemical Engineering**

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) -- ISC2
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Salary Expectation: GBP 85,000-100,000+ | Hybrid (London/UK)